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Market Briefs Pro

Read Less News

Good morning, Pro Briefers!

The world wants robots that can do anything - and every day, advanced robotics is looking less like science fiction and more like a reality.

Why? *Investment dollars.* More money has been flowing into robotics innovations, which is making the tech better.

Plus, AI has made developing robots much faster - what used to take years of research and testing now can be done in months.

In short - the potential ways for investors to profit from these advancements in robotics are growing.

We first spotted this Innovation Shift back in October 2025 and our thesis was simple: Physical automation was approaching a turning point, and the companies building that infrastructure stood to benefit for years.

The highlights from our last robotics report:

- The global robotics market was projected to grow at a 19% compound annual rate, with AI-powered automation expected to reach $111 billion by 2030.

- Nvidia called robotics the next "multi-trillion dollar industry."

Companies laying the foundation for the next generation of automation are in a position to grow alongside an industry that is just getting started.

Where are we today? The bigger picture has not changed - if anything, the pace has picked up.

Nvidia unveiled a reasoning model purpose-built for humanoid robots at CES 2026.

Intuitive Surgical received FDA clearance for its da Vinci 5 program to perform cardiac surgery robotically for the first time in history.

A new U.S. manufacturing hub opened specifically to produce collaborative robots on American soil.

The infrastructure we pointed to in October is being built faster than most expected.

And while we identified this shift correctly, not every company in it has performed as we anticipated - for better or for worse.

Let’s take a look back at the opportunities we identified and show you what we’re buying more of, what we’re holding, selling, and two new names that might be worth considering.

ANALYST TAKE

Tickers we're tracking:

What we're buying: AMZN, NVDA

What we're holding: BOTZ

What we're selling: SYM

What we're adding: TER, ISRG

WHAT WE'RE BUYING

Two Stocks We're Buying More Of

Amazon (AMZN)

Amazon is down around 1% since October as of March 5th, 2026 - most of the drop is related to the global conflicts that broke out in late February and early March, 2026.

Still, Amazon is one of the largest robotics producers in the world - so growth in robotics means growth for Amazon.

Amazon's robotic warehouse network was already massive when we wrote about it.

What has changed is where the company is taking things next.

It is now testing humanoid robots for delivery operations - the kind that could one day handle the final leg of getting a package to your door.

That is a meaningful step beyond warehouse automation.

Amazon.com, Inc. (AMZN)

Data via Briefs Terminal

At the same time, Walmart dropped $520 million into its own robotics buildout.

That is Amazon's biggest competitor in physical retail responding to the same pressure Amazon has been applying for years.

When a competitor starts spending at that level to catch up, it is usually a sign that the leader is further ahead than the headline numbers reflect.

Every robot Amazon adds to its network makes the cost of competing with it higher. That advantage compounds with each passing quarter advantage compounds with each passing quarter.

So despite its recent drop, which is mostly related to macro risks not business risks, we're buying more of Amazon right now.

Nvidia (NVDA)

Nvidia has fallen around 2% since October as of March 5th, 2026. Once again - its struggles are largely due to a wider selloff, rather than financial underperformance.

But stock price and business progress are not always the same thing in the short run, and Nvidia is a good example of why.

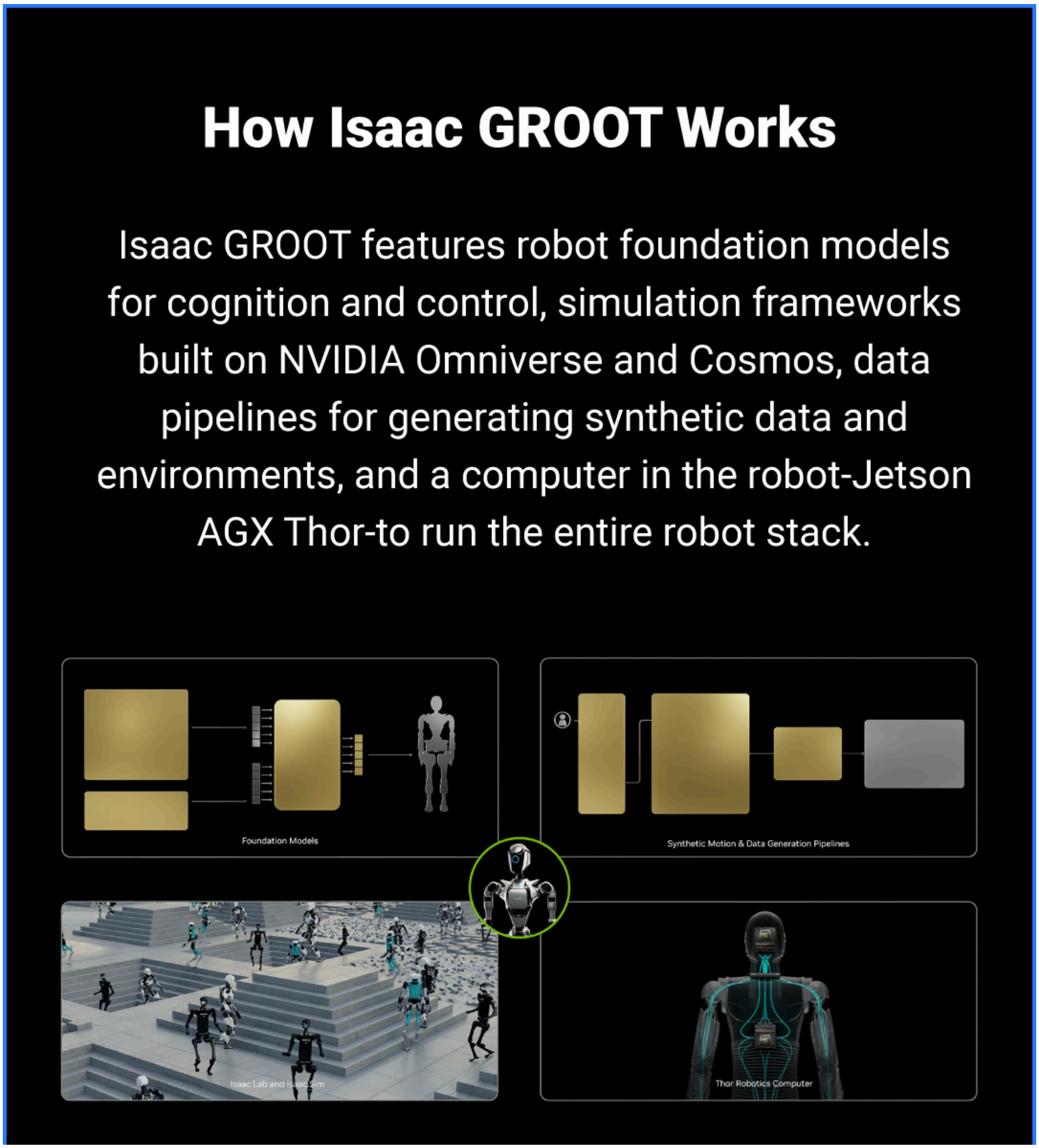


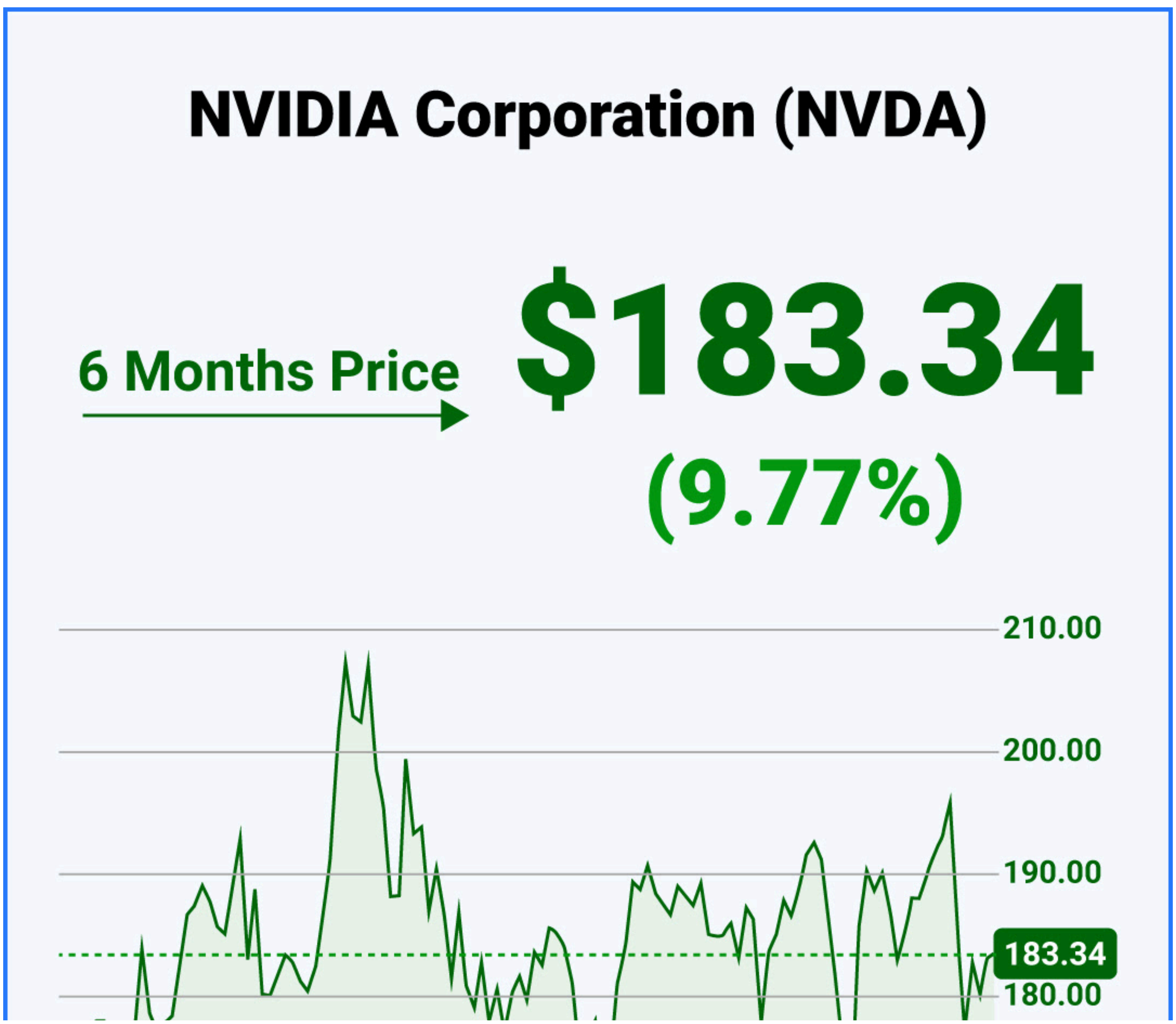
Image via Nvidia

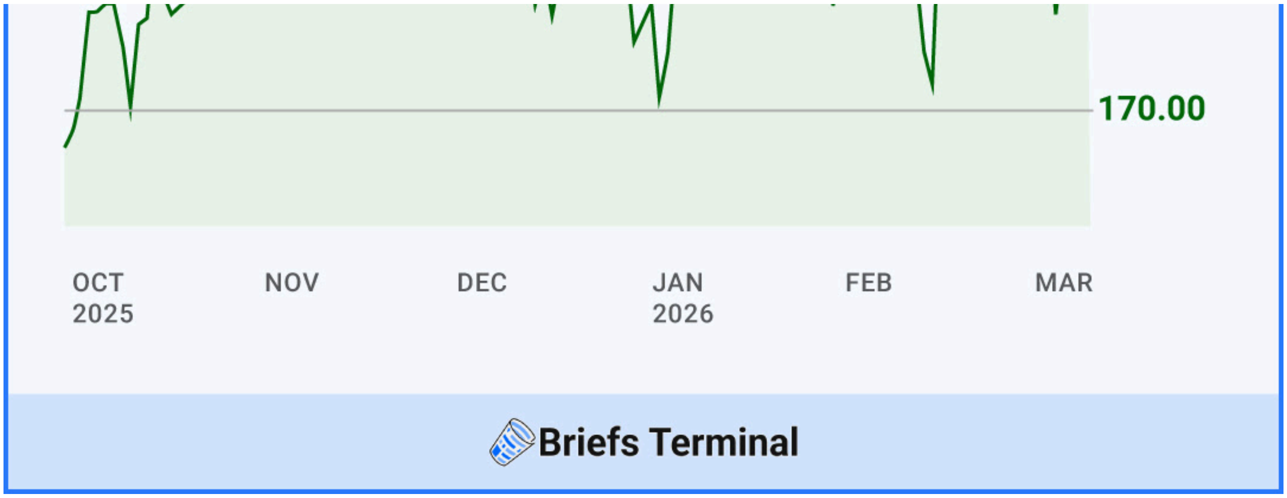
The company unveiled GROOT 1.6 at CES 2026 that was built from the ground up to power humanoid robots - giving machines the ability to see, think, and control movement all at once.

- GROOT AI model that helps robots to understand, learn skills, and interact with the world.

Millions of developers worldwide are now using Nvidia's software for their robots, as it's one of the most powerful tools in robotics to date.

It also inked new partnerships with Boston Dynamics, Caterpillar, and LG.





Data via Briefs Terminal

The picture that is forming here is bigger than the chip business Nvidia is already known for.

Every humanoid robot that goes into production needs a software brain.

Nvidia is working to become the standard answer to that problem across the industry - no matter which company ends up winning the hardware race.

That kind of positioning, if it holds, compounds in value over time.

As a result, we still see Nvidia as an opportunity for investors in the robotics industry.

WHAT WE'RE HOLDING

The ETF We're Holding

BOTZ ETF

Our one and only hold in this shift is an ETF: BOTZ.

The Global X Robotics and Artificial Intelligence ETF (BOTZ) holds a mix of U.S. robotics companies and Japanese industrial manufacturers.

So when the Japanese names lag, the whole fund feels it, despite it having exposure to U.S. robotics companies.

The result? Investors who buy shares in this ETF gain exposure to the industry, but any gains are watered down by manufacturing misses, as it's not solely concentrated in gains are watered down by manufacturing misses, as it's not solely concentrated in robotics.

The BOTZ ETF is up just over 2% since October as of March 5th, 2026.

- The S&P 500 is up around 3% in the last six months as of March 5th, 2026.

For investors who want a single ticker that touches the robotics space broadly, BOTZ achieves that goal.

Data [via] Briefs Terminal

However, for investors who want more targeted exposure, the individual names in this report likely serve that goal better.

With that said, we're holding onto this ETF for now, as it has the potential to blossom into something bigger if robotics continues to take off.

WHAT WE'RE SELLING

Dropping From Our List

Symbotic (SYM)

Symbotic is the last name from our previous report - and over the last 6 months, shares have flipped.

As of March 5th, 2026, shares of Symbotic are down over 8%, lagging the S&P 500.

Reminder: Symbotic creates advanced robots that automate supply chains.

But the story for Symbotic is complicated - shares are falling, but the company's actual business improved over that same stretch.

- Revenue grew 26% year-over-year.
- The company posted its first profitable quarter.
- It brought in a new customer outside of retail for the first time.

Data via Briefs Terminal

Here's the details: Symbotic has $22.5 billion in orders it's working through right now.

The problem is that more than half of it - roughly $11.6 billion - is tied to a joint venture called GreenBox that Symbotic partly owns.

GreenBox has not brought in a single outside customer in over two years of existence.

The market may be questioning whether its financials are solid.

- Goldman Sachs downgraded the stock to sell in December 2025.

Since our last report, the company has also diluted its own shares, was flagged for insider selling, and Barclays issued a sell rating for it.

It's unclear when this GreenBox situation will be resolved or if Symbotic will make any more progress with its products.

In the meantime, we're selling and do not see it as an opportunity currently for investors.

WHAT WE'RE ADDING

Two New Opportunities

When you think of robotics, you probably think of the robot itself.

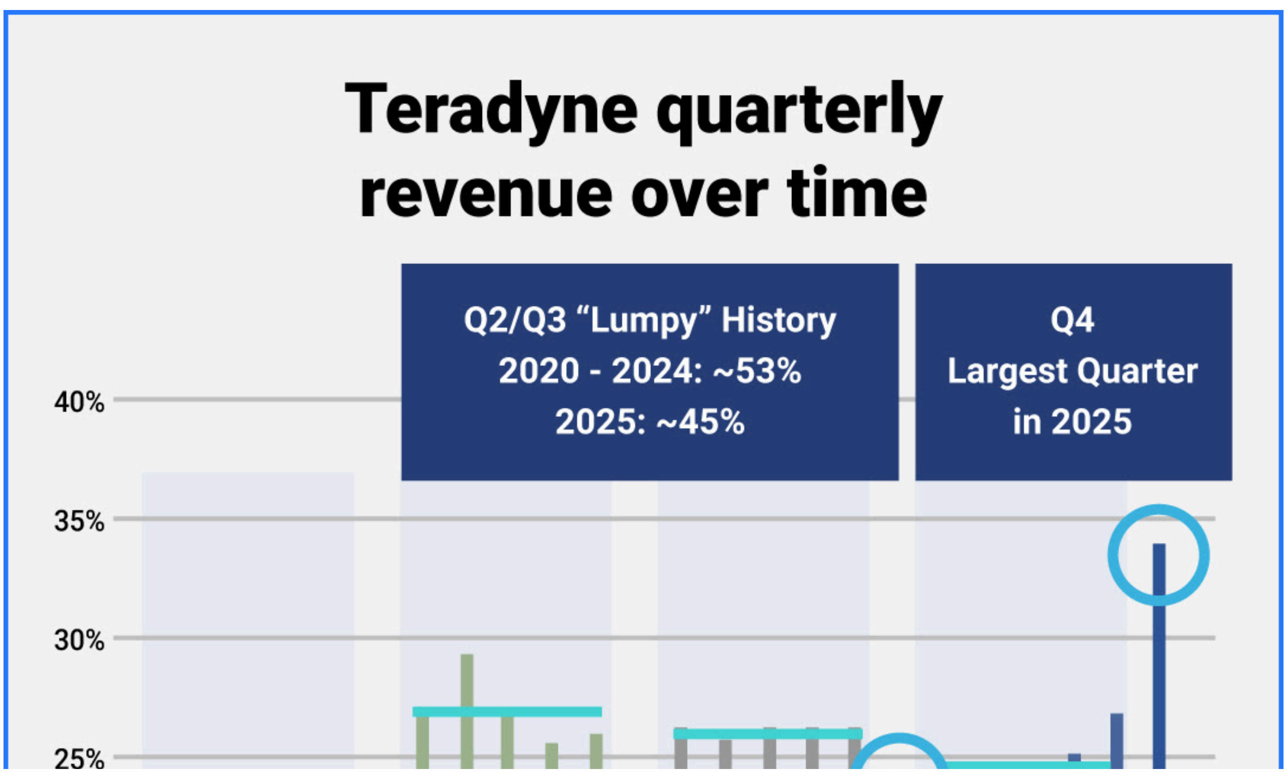
But there's a lot more that is going on behind the scenes, especially when it comes to the tech and testing of these robots.

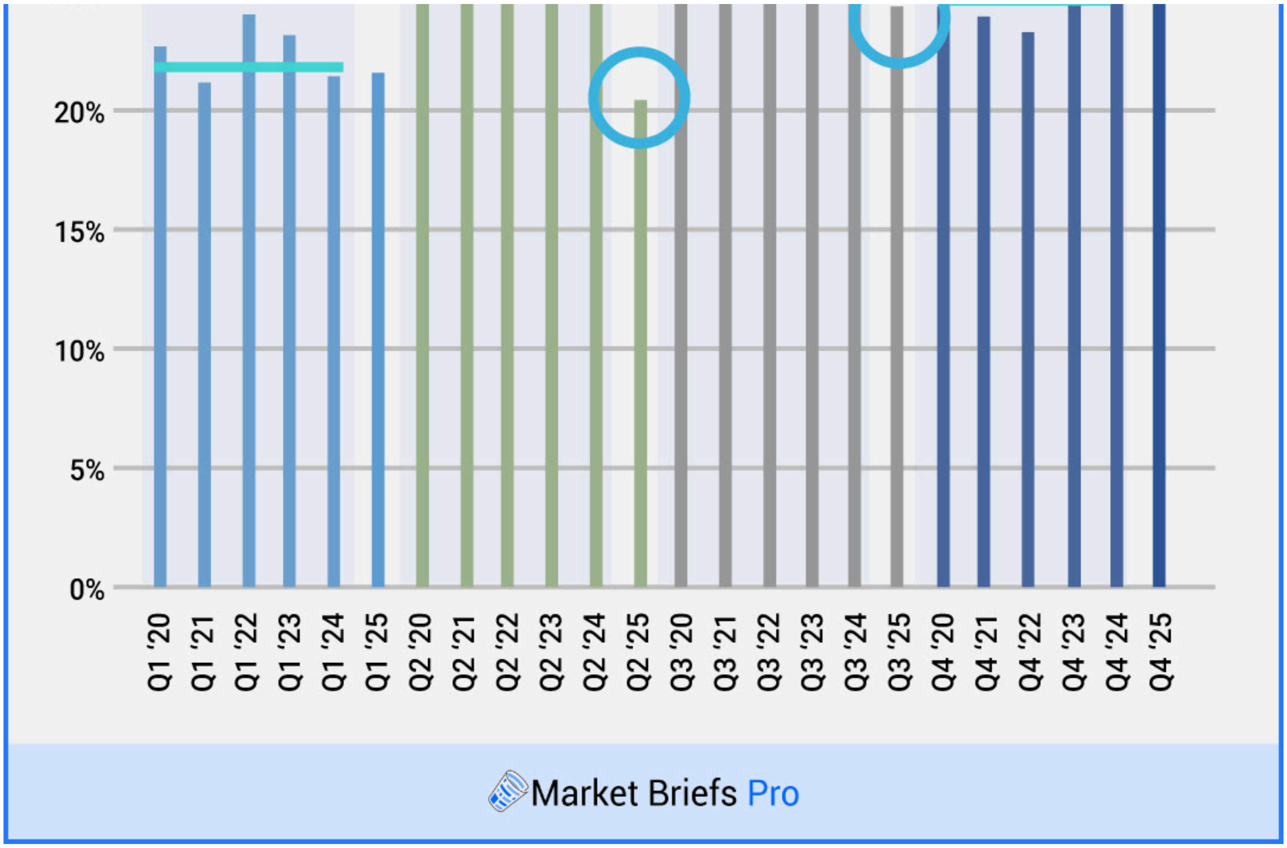
Teradyne (TER) is a different kind of opportunity - the company tests the chips that go inside robots, and also helps make them.

The business has two parts:

One is semiconductor testing. Teradyne is one of only two companies in the world that can test the most advanced AI chips and memory at scale - the kind of testing that every chipmaker needs before a product ships.

The other part is Universal Robots - a separate company owned by Teradyne - which makes collaborative robots.





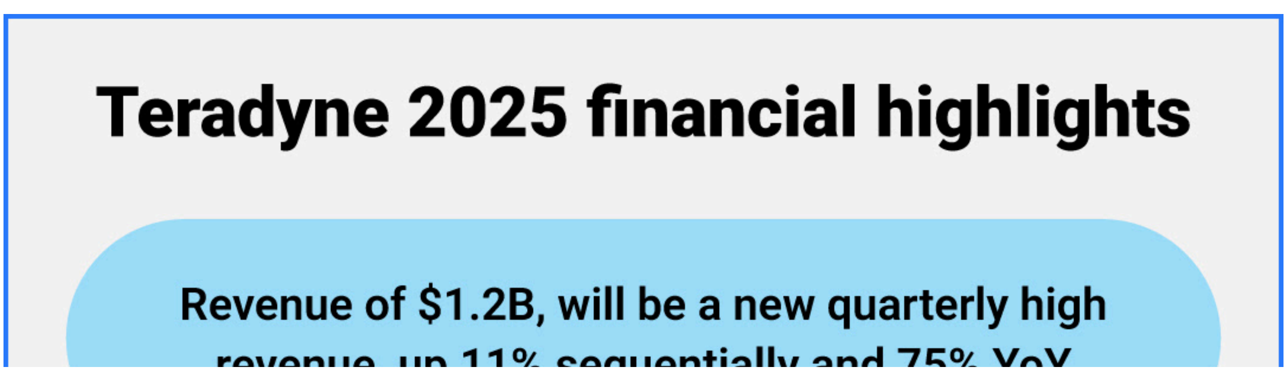
Data via Teradyne's investor presentation

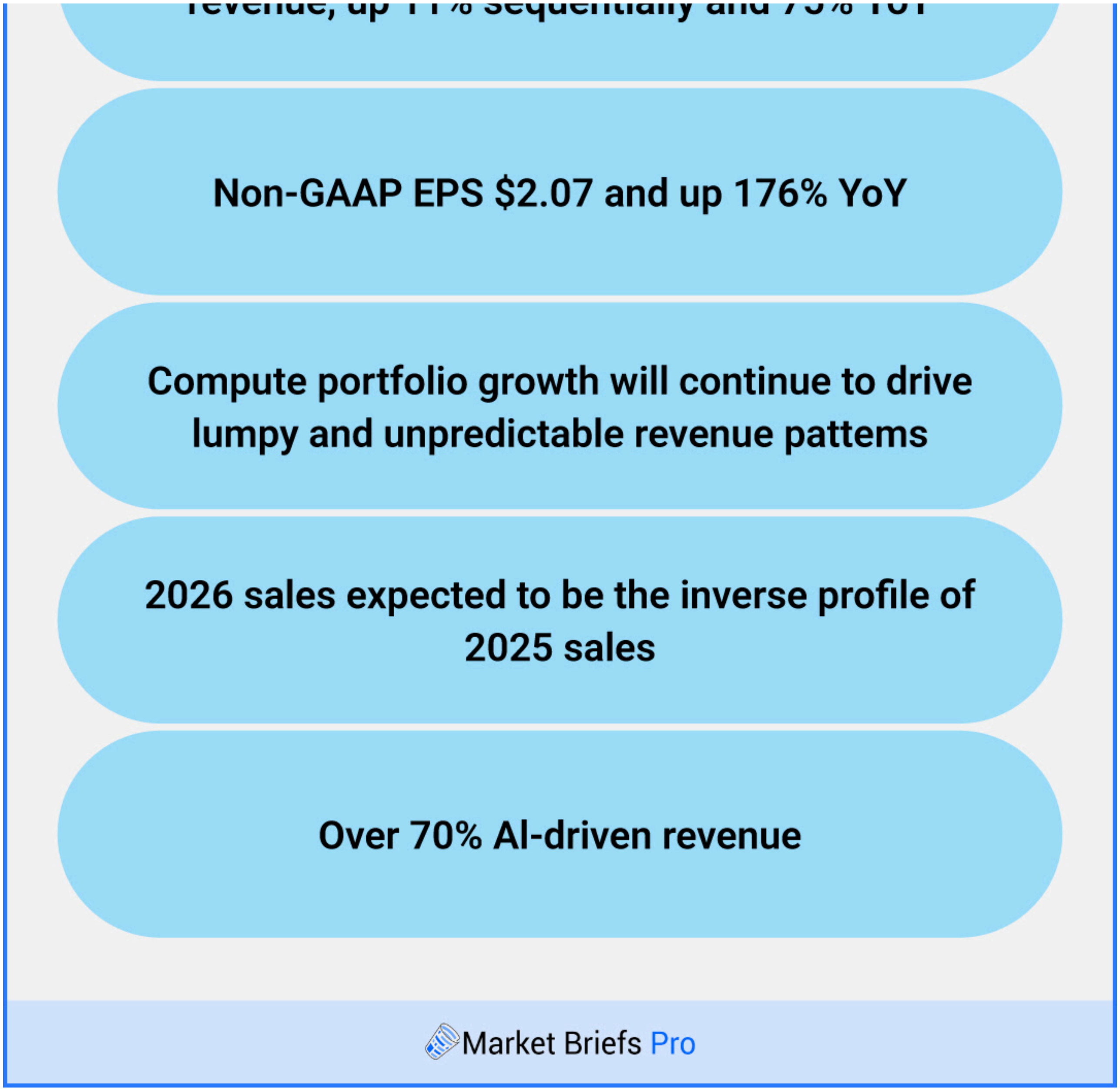
These are smaller, flexible machines designed to work directly alongside people on the job, rather than operate in fully automated environments.

By the numbers for its latest quarterly earnings:

- Revenue came in at $1.08 billion, up 44% year over year.
- Earnings per share jumped from $0.95 to $1.80.
- AI-related business now accounts for more than 60% of quarterly revenue, with management is expecting that figure to cross 70% in the next quarter.

Another potential catalyst may be around the corner as well.





Data via Teradyne's investor presentation

A new generation of memory technology called HBM4 is expected to begin rolling out in 2026 and 2027.

- Micron, Samsung, and SK Hynix are the companies primarily working on HBM4 memory.

It will require a completely new round of testing equipment - which benefits Teradyne as one of the only companies that can test these chips.

The opportunity? That replacement cycle has not started yet, which means the revenue from it may not yet be reflected in the stock price.

Plus, the company recently opened a $32 million U.S. manufacturing hub in Michigan to

Plus, the company recently opened a $62 million U.S. manufacturing hub in Michigan to produce Universal Robots domestically - and service revenue from this hub is growing.

Analyst note: Teradyne is trading near a record high.

Investors considering it will want to pay attention to its next earnings report set to drop this coming April, which will impact the direction its shares go in next.

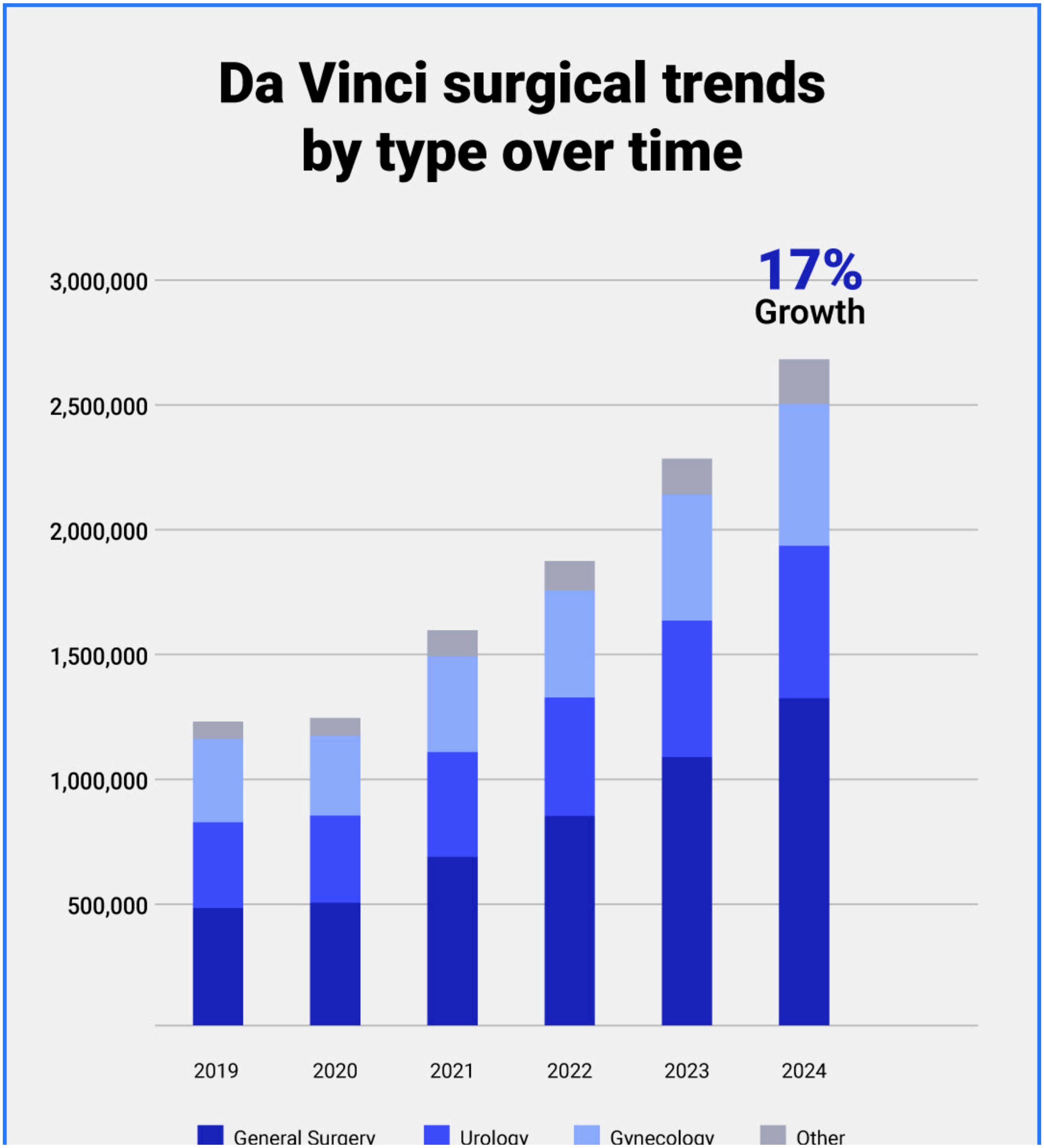
Data via Briefs Terminal

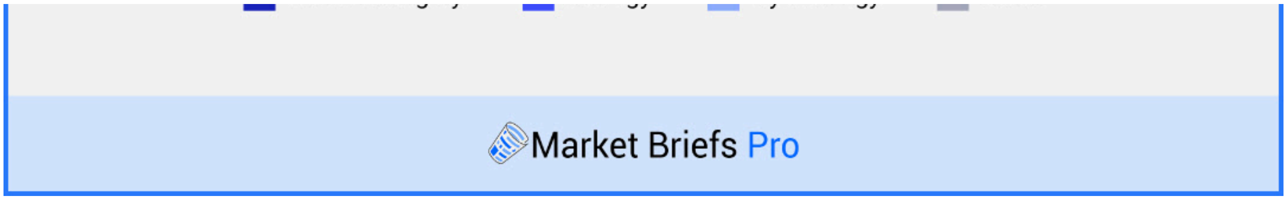
Intuitive Surgical (ISRG)

Lastly, we have Intuitive Surgical - a company specializing in surgical robots for minimally invasive surgeries.

Intuitive Surgical (ISRG) makes the da Vinci surgical robot, which is installed in more than 11,100 hospitals around the world.

Once a hospital builds its surgical workflows around the system, it’s very costly to move.





Data via Intuitive Surgical's investor presentation

Full-year 2025 revenue for Intuitive Surgical reached $10.1 billion, up more than 20% from the year before.

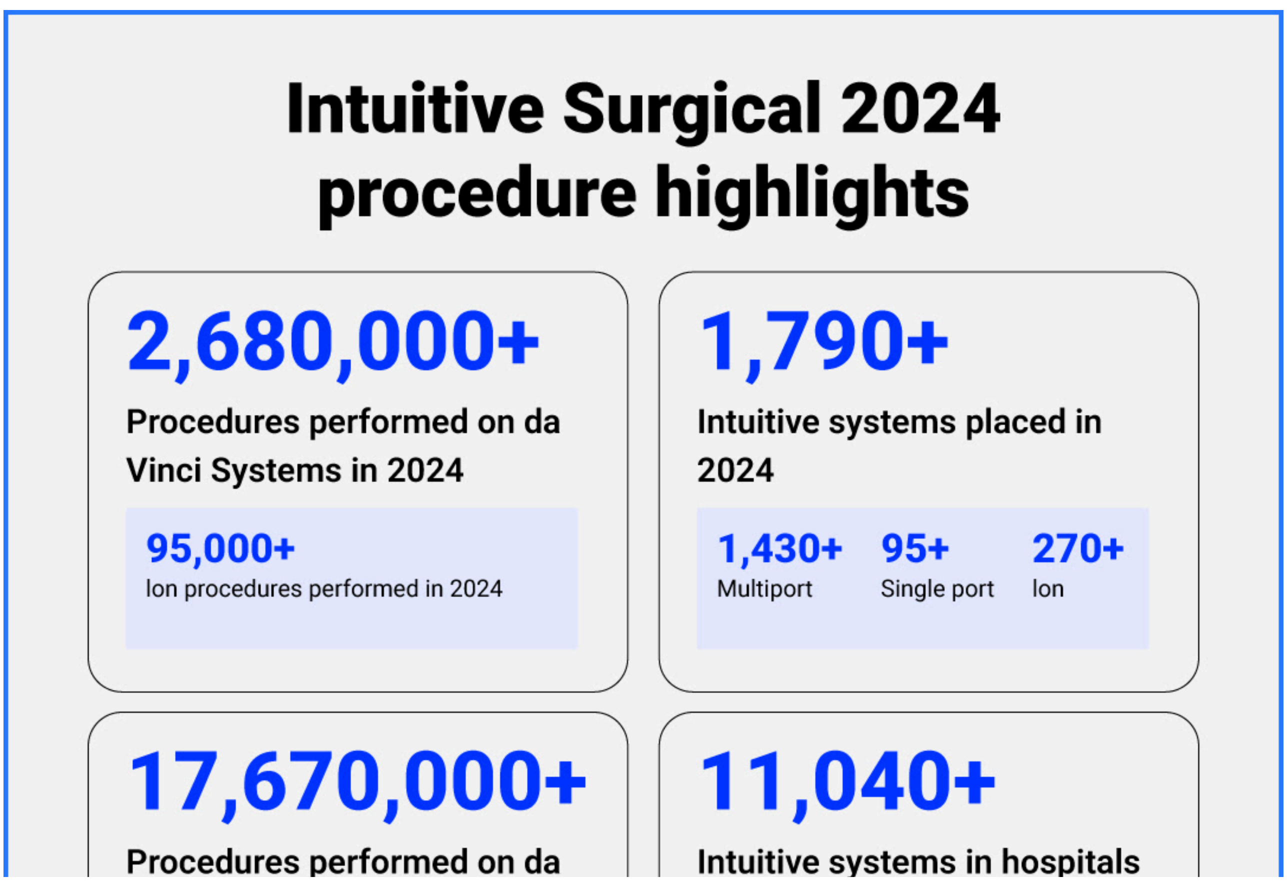
The company performed procedures on 3.1 million patients, up 18%, and roughly 85 cents of every dollar earned came from recurring revenue.

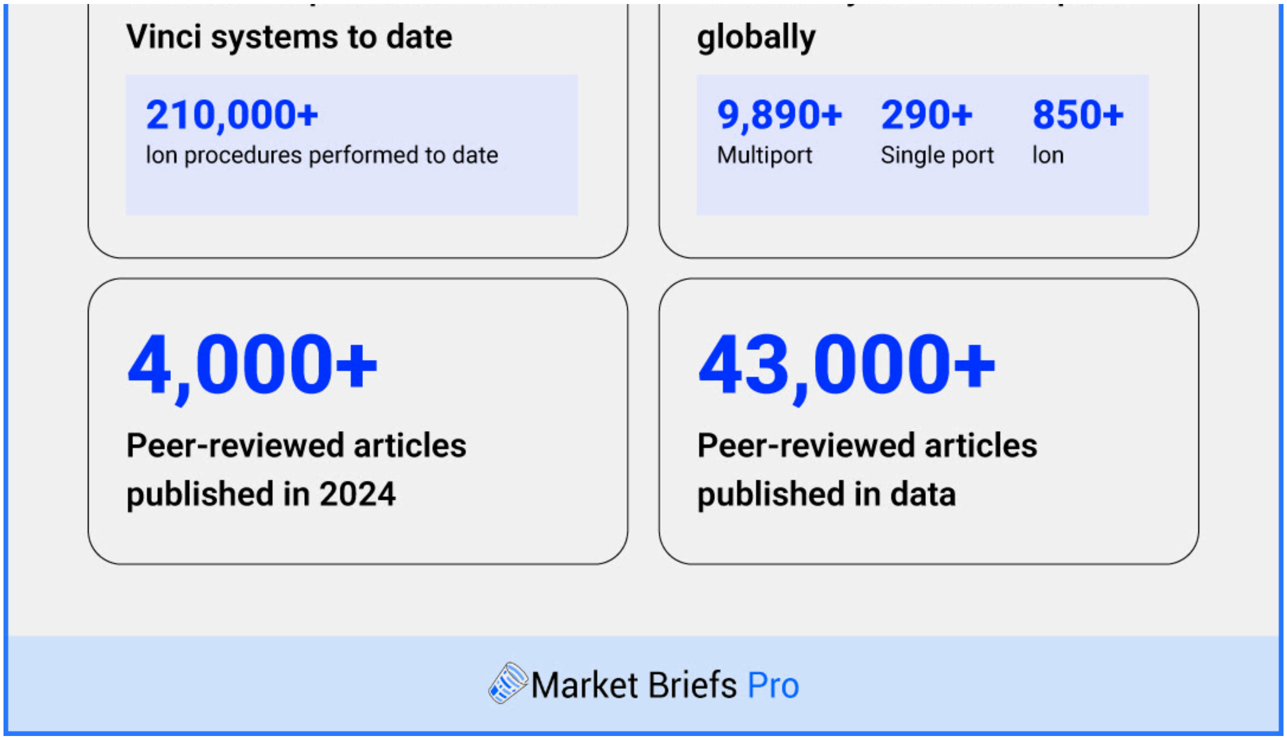
But, the stock is down just under 12% in 2026, as of March 5th.

The market appears to be pricing in a slowdown in its business, but something else may be happening here.

In January 2026, da Vinci 5 received FDA clearance to perform certain cardiac procedures for the first time.

Cardiac surgery is a new category entirely for robotics, and one of the highest-value areas in medicine.





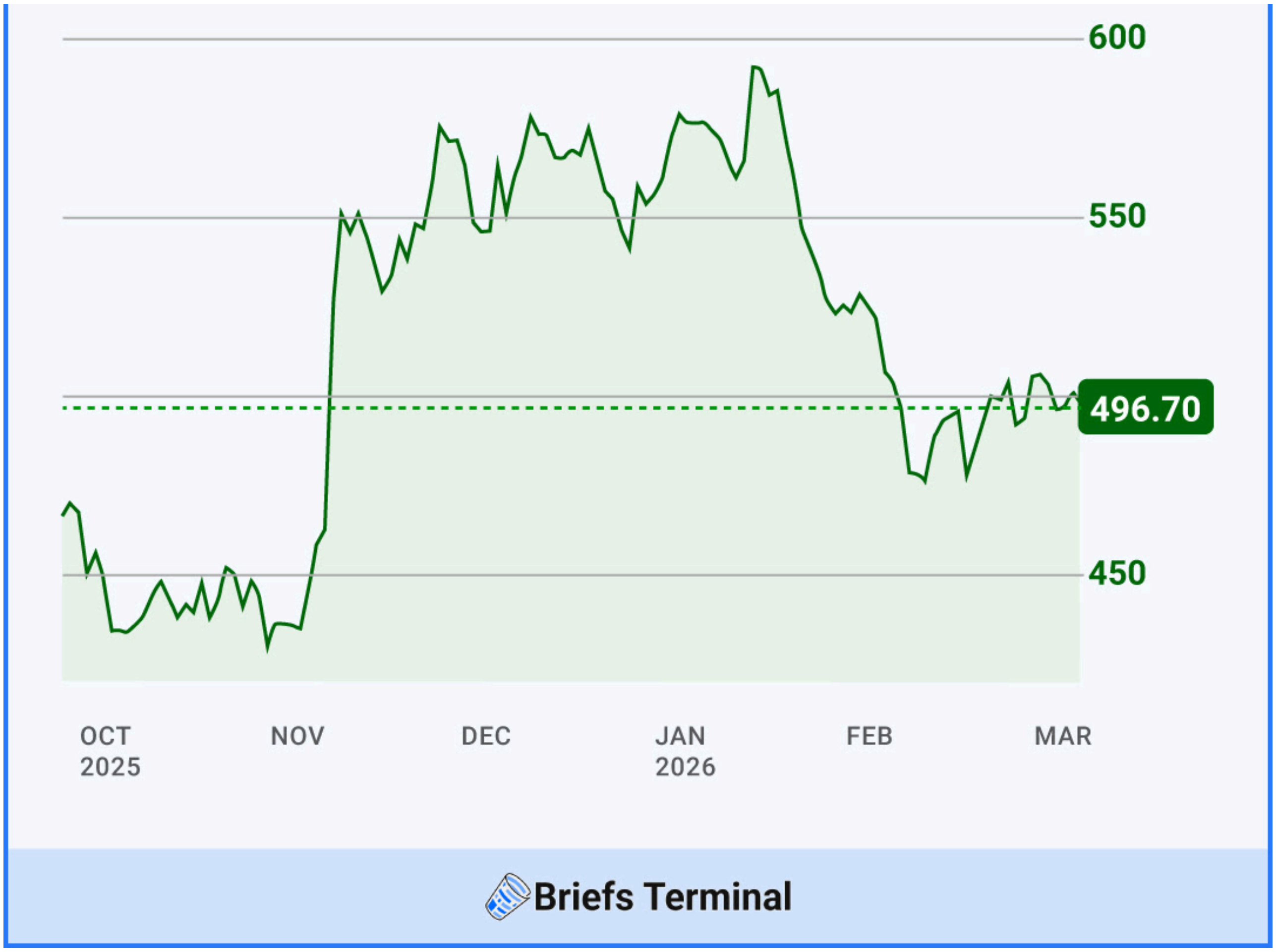
Data via Intuitive Surgical's investor presentation

On top of that, the company is expanding in Japan - we believe that both of these factors are not yet priced into its stock.

The concern? *Competition.*

Medtronic's robotic surgery system received FDA clearance in late 2025 and performed its first U.S. procedures in early 2026.

Johnson and Johnson has a competing system with a pending FDA submission.



Data via Briefs Terminal

New entrants are far more likely to compete for hospitals that have not yet adopted any robotic surgery system than to pull existing customers away from a platform they have spent years building around.

That gives Intuitive a head start - but challenges are getting better in this space.

At the moment though, the stock could be undervalued, which may provide a unique opportunity for investors.

RISKS

How This Shift Could Change

First, many robotics companies are not yet profitable, and the way they stay funded is by selling new shares.

That shrinks the value of every existing share, even if the business itself is growing.

Second, this market punishes missed timelines.

In a sector where so much of a stock's value is based on future expectations, a delayed product launch or a pulled guidance number can reset a stock price before the company has a chance to provide context.

Third is the pace of technological change.

What looks like a durable competitive advantage in robotics and AI today can be eroded faster than most traditional industries would suggest.

Companies operating at the platform level - those whose tools multiple hardware makers depend on - carry less of this risk than businesses built around a single product or approach.

Next is policy - there are several things shifting at once in robotics right now, like reshoring incentives, defense modernization budgets, and domestic manufacturing priorities.

These are tied to the current political environment. Those conditions may shift again in the future.

Finally, there's SpaceX, which sounds unrelated at first, but really isn’t.

A public offering from SpaceX would rank among the largest capital market events in recent history.

Investors may rotate out of robotics and into space as a result.

That may create pressure for these robotics companies and put them on the sideline while SpaceX takes center stage.

REVIEW

The Future Is Now With Robotics

Our core thesis on robotics remains the same: The technology is advancing, the institutional money is arriving, and the companies doing real work are beginning to separate from the ones that were mostly story.

Companies like Amazon and Nvidia have strengthened their position in the space, despite recent market volatility.

ETFs like BOTZ give investors exposure, but also the risks of foreign manufacturing companies.

And Symbotic hasn't worked out its issues yet - meanwhile, Teradyne and Intuitive Surgical are under the radar and potentially ready to explode in the near future.

Our strategy going forward: Look for companies where the business results and the underlying credibility are both moving in the same direction.

Companies that do both of those things could shape up to be long term opportunities that investors may want to consider for years to come.

- **Market Briefs Pro Team**

*The Market Briefs Pro team often invests in the same stocks and assets we cover.

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You are never guaranteed to make money when you invest, you might even lose money. If you're looking for personalized financial advice, we highly recommend speaking with a licensed financial advisor.

Our mission? It's simple - to help you be better with money.

Included interviews have been edited for length and clarity.